

FABIENNEWINTLETOURISMTRIBEEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we are at the Arrival 360 event in Brisbane and I've run into Fabian Wintle from Tourism Tribe. And Fabian, or Fab as they call you, welcome to the program. Thank you so much, Geoff.

Tourism Tribe, tell us a bit about it. What sort of thing do you do with the travel industry? Well, we started many moons ago upskilling tourism businesses, mainly focusing on the independent ones with the tools and knowledge to better market themselves online and run a better, more efficient business. Obviously now it's all switched to AI, so we are still in ensuring that they're being found in the LLMs, but also looking at what is under the waterline, how I call it, and making sure that they're working towards being AI queryable so that when the tech is there for small businesses to use tools like Claude, the way they use Canva without having to install it and integrate APIs, et cetera, they can do it.

So yeah, I'm an AI tragic. Oh, wow. Now AI is really taking over industries in the whole world, isn't it? And it has some downsides, but mostly it's overall pretty fantastic.

Yeah. I mean, if you are a business owner and there's so many of them in our industry, independent businesses, someone who've had an idea, they've seen an opportunity for an experience product, they probably have had so many great ideas of what they could be doing in their mind, but never had the money just like us to implement it or create an app or create a system or create automatic social media posts. And now's the time where they go, wow, things can just happen.

You just describe what good looks like to a tool like Claude or Codex, and then everything can happen by vibe coding. Yeah. It's certainly helped me.

Things like ChatGPT when you are researching things or you need a bit of help with something, it's becoming so normal now to use that. And just a year or so ago, people didn't even know what ChatGPT or any of those were. I started using it in 2023, interestingly, and there was no Claude Code a year ago.

The opportunity has changed a lot, but I feel like tourism operators are still using ChatGPT for contacts, whereas there's so many new things that it could be used for. And this is where we sit or they use ChatGPT themselves. Or let's say you have a long drive and you talk to chat and then they go, right, how do I make sure that my website is found in these tools? Yeah.

So there's a few techniques that need to happen. And if anyone's listening, you need to do what is called schema. So you need to make sure that you put the right barcode on your specific page of your website.

So the AI understands what you're about, because when you talk to ChatGPT, it's strained up to

a specific month of a specific year, and then it goes freestyle and researches. And when it researches, it can't read all your web pages. So it just reads that meta information, that quick executive summary.

And that's why it's so important. Yeah. And I didn't know that myself.

And I have to put that on my websites to make sure that things like Travel Radio Australia have that stripe on there where it can be found with ChatGPT. My name, I have another person in radio who's exactly the same name as me and ChatGPT gets us confused because it's looking just for that name and mixes up our backgrounds and things like that. And I suppose it can, if you have a stripe on your information, it can really separate that out.

That's right. You need that. But there is still exactly like in the region where I live, there's been a tourist attraction that's been shut for many years.

And every so often it still brings it up. So it's really hard to alter the perception that chat gives to people if the whole region hasn't implemented these elements. So what we find is, you know, previously destination tourism organizations role, they were the authority in the region, but now the authority is different because chat connects straight, connects the consumer straight to the operator.

And if, for example, if we think about Gemini and the changes in Google that they announced at Google IO, Google business profile is the most important asset any business can have now. Google's AI is based on that. So if the operator hasn't fully updated it or hasn't added posts or nurtured that listing, the perception about your region is altered by what signals Google can see from these listings.

Yeah. It's a fantastic program that you have and the insights into this technology that a lot of us don't understand yet. I think it's going to take us another few years to get our heads around it completely.

And by then it's probably going to be all changed again to Fabian Wintel and she's from Tourism Tribe. You were telling me you had a big background in Gold Coast tourism, my old stamping ground from the nineties. And we were having a laugh about the Metamades and all those sorts of things that probably you could never get away with these days.

Yeah, that's right. I don't know if I'd say a big background, but when I moved from Switzerland to Australia, my first job that I landed at was at Gold Coast Tourism, where I've met a lot of people from the industry and you and I were having a good chat going, oh my goodness, the Metamades, but they were so iconic, right? It was brand Gold Coast. It was.

And for those overseas who don't know what the Metamades were, they were young ladies running around in gold bikinis in surface paradise, feeding car meters, you know, parking meters

for people who overstayed their time. And it was a council service. It was provided by the council.

Yeah. And you could have your photo taken with them and everything. And it was really big for a while, you know, for many, probably 50 years.

Everyone still has a photo, right? They do. They do. It was a total, totally different time back on the Gold Coast then.

And it's a bit of a shame that a lot of the fun part of the Gold Coast has gone away a bit now, but it's still a very popular destination for over two or three million visitors a year there. But yeah, but it's been great. And how can people find out more about Tourism Tribe online, Fabienne? Oh, well, it's very easy because there's no other Fabienne Wintle in the world.

And if you just Google Fabienne Tourism Tribe or Fabienne Wintle, you'll find us. As I was telling you, you know, about Schema, we have a lot of information online on our blog written in plain English for tourism operators. So what you can do is send your AI agent to read our blog and tell you what you need to change currently in your business based on what it's run, what it's read.

So you can use our content as experts in AI for tourism, giving some context to your chat GPT agent. And yeah, it'll tell you what to do. It'll write your own schema and you tell it what content management system you have, and it'll tell you how to put it in.

That's so fascinating. Fabienne, thank you so much for being on the program and appearing with us on Travel Radio Australia. Thanks, Geoff.